

the 1990s, the number of people in the UK who are obese has increased by 50% (Health Survey for England 1995, 1997, 1999, 2001, 2003). The prevalence of obesity in the UK is now 10% in men and 13% in women (Health Survey for England 2003). The prevalence of obesity in the USA is 15% in men and 20% in women (Flegal et al. 2002). The prevalence of obesity in the USA is higher than in the UK, but the prevalence of obesity in the UK is increasing rapidly. The prevalence of obesity in the UK is expected to reach 15% in men and 20% in women by 2010 (Health Survey for England 2003).

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